CoreWeave Inc. (CRWV)

Upgrade to Buy: NTM datapoints on contract economics are likely to be more positive than the market expects

CRWV	12m Price Target: **$106.00**	Price: **$61.39**	Upside: **72.7%**

We upgrade CoreWeave from Neutral to Buy with 73% upside to our price target of $106 (down from $139 prior). The stock is down 43% since Aug 11 (2Q EPS) and 24% in the last 5 trading days, per our understanding due to a) ongoing volatility in the credit market, which raises questions on if and at what rate CoreWeave will be able to finance their next phase of growth; b) debate on demand for intelligence at the frontier vs. off frontier, and whether changing mix impacts token monetization at CoreWeave's customers, which in turn is key for the ecosystem to realize returns on compute investments. **Going back to Finance 101, we see CoreWeave's enterprise value as being directly correlated to the magnitude and durability of the spread between its unlevered IRR and WACC — and we think investors may be underestimating the magnitude of upward revisions to uIRR, and overestimating the magnitude of upward revisions to WACC:**

- We believe CoreWeave's ARR per MW, and therefore unlevered IRR, is biased to the upside in the next 24 months because of tight supply, as well as our view that CoreWeave is differentiated from other neoclouds in its performance/cost metrics and its ability to execute on ramping new supply;
- We estimate CoreWeave's blended cost of debt could move 100-200bps but likely not more than that, ultimately putting a cap on WACC such that equity return profiles will still be attractive, based on feedback from our industry credit conversations. We summarize current bond trading levels below - while unsecured debt trades at 13.5-15.0% YTW, we do not think that this would be representative of the company's new cost of financing as CoreWeave's financing structure is primarily asset-based.

We recognize the challenges with forecasting out further in time, and in particular, predicting when supply/demand will ultimately

BUY

Gabriela Borges, CFA
+1(212)902-7839 | gabriela.borges@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Maura Hager
+1(212)9028724 | maura.hager@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Key Data

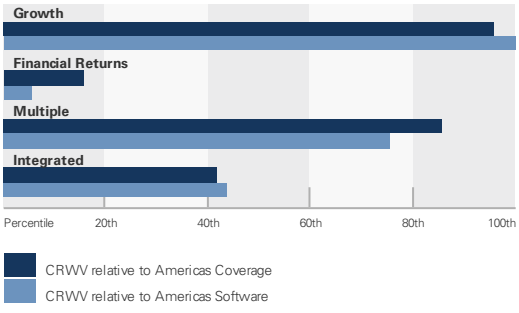
Market cap: $37.3bn
Enterprise value: $84.9bn
3m ADTV: $2.7bn
United States
Americas Software
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue ($ mn) New	**5,131.1**	**12,960.1**	**27,529.3**	**47,535.0**
Revenue ($ mn) Old	5,131.1	12,957.1	27,245.3	44,185.2
EBITDA ($ mn)	3,094.6	7,693.2	18,180.8	32,673.6
EBIT ($ mn)	667.2	1,069.3	4,371.4	10,176.6
EPS ($) New	**(1.40)**	**(3.80)**	**(2.34)**	**3.36**
EPS ($) Old	(1.40)	(3.64)	(2.90)	(1.15)
P/E (X)	NM	NM	NM	18.3
Dividend yield (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	6.0	6.2	4.2	2.8

	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
EPS ($)	(1.03)	(1.11)	(0.56)	(0.79)

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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BUY

CoreWeave Inc. (CRWV)

Rating since Oct 19, 2026

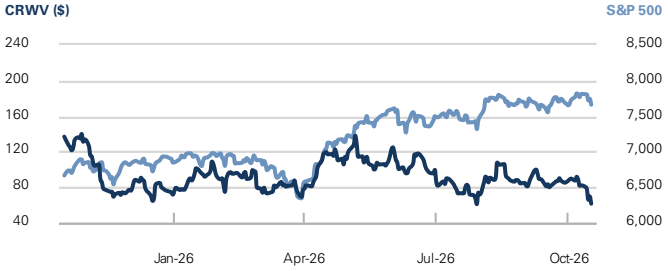
Ratios & Valuation

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
P/E (X)	NM	NM	NM	18.3
EV/EBITDA (X)	20.5	10.6	6.2	4.0
EV/sales (X)	12.4	6.3	4.1	2.7
FCF yield (%)	(16.2)	(82.9)	(77.2)	(41.2)
EV/DACF (X)	20.7	13.3	8.3	5.5
CROCI (%)	13.2	12.2	14.5	18.9
ROE (%)	(26.1)	(56.9)	(42.7)	57.8
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	6.0	6.2	4.2	2.8
Net debt/equity (%)	554.7	1,173.4	3,058.6	1,929.5
Interest cover (X)	0.5	0.3	0.7	1.3
Inventory days	NM	NM	NM	NM
Receivable days	127.5	106.7	60.2	43.5
Days payable outstanding	316.2	285.5	299.0	296.8

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue growth	167.9	152.6	112.4	72.7
EBITDA growth	156.0	147.2	135.6	79.7
EPS growth	(368.4)	(172.1)	38.3	243.3
DPS growth	(100.0)	NM	NM	NM
Gross margin	72.0	66.5	67.5	68.0
EBIT margin	13.0	8.3	15.9	21.4

Price Performance



	3m	6m	12m
Absolute	(15.8)%	(48.7)%	(56.7)%
Rel. to the S&P 500	(17.2)%	(52.8)%	(62.5)%

Source: FactSet. Price as of 16 Oct 2026 close.

Income Statement ($ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue	5,131.1	12,960.1	27,529.3	47,535.0
Cost of goods sold	(1,437.9)	(4,347.2)	(8,947.0)	(15,211.2)
SG&A	(3,026.0)	(7,543.6)	(14,210.8)	(22,147.3)
R&D	–	–	–	–
Other operating inc./(exp.)	–	–	–	–
EBITDA	**3,121.2**	**7,715.2**	**18,180.8**	**32,673.6**
Depreciation & amortization	(2,454.0)	(6,645.9)	(13,809.4)	(22,497.0)
EBIT	**667.2**	**1,069.3**	**4,371.4**	**10,176.6**
Net interest inc./(exp.)	(1,229.4)	(3,173.1)	(6,024.2)	(8,024.8)
Income/(loss) from associates	–	–	–	–
Pre-tax profit	**(523.4)**	**(1,813.7)**	**(1,152.8)**	**2,651.8**
Provision for taxes	(82.3)	(287.3)	(242.1)	(556.9)
Minority interest	–	–	–	–
Preferred dividends	–	–	–	–
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	**(605.7)**	**(2,101.1)**	**(1,394.9)**	**2,094.9**
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	**(1,167.3)**	**(2,836.9)**	**(2,394.2)**	**1,378.2**
EPS (basic, pre-except) ($)	**(1.40)**	**(3.80)**	**(2.34)**	**3.36**
EPS (diluted, pre-except) ($)	**(1.40)**	**(3.80)**	**(2.34)**	**3.36**
EPS (ex-ESO exp., dil.) ($)	**--**	**--**	**--**	**--**
DPS ($)	–	–	–	–
Div. payout ratio (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Wtd avg shares out. (basic) (mn)	434.0	553.3	595.1	623.8
Wtd avg shares out. (diluted) (mn)	434.9	553.3	595.1	623.8

Balance Sheet ($ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Cash & cash equivalents	3,127.0	2,971.9	1,190.9	5,273.2
Accounts receivable	3,169.0	4,408.6	4,667.0	6,650.8
Inventory	–	–	–	–
Other current assets	1,158.0	1,687.2	2,278.8	2,837.7
Total current assets	**7,488.0**	**9,082.7**	**8,151.7**	**14,776.7**
Net PP&E	38,788.0	95,125.0	139,073.4	190,300.6
Net intangibles	1,336.0	1,346.0	1,346.0	1,346.0
Total investments	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other long-term assets	1,690.0	2,873.0	2,873.0	2,873.0
Total assets	**49,302.0**	**108,426.7**	**151,444.1**	**209,296.3**
Accounts payable	1,623.0	5,176.9	9,481.3	15,258.6
Short-term debt	6,746.0	6,528.6	6,661.4	6,454.4
Current lease liabilities	427.0	1,057.0	1,198.5	1,868.5
Other current liabilities	7,644.0	9,671.6	16,561.3	23,700.1
Total current liabilities	**16,440.0**	**22,434.1**	**33,902.4**	**47,281.6**
Long-term debt	14,881.0	43,985.5	70,481.9	90,829.9
Non-current lease liabilities	7,768.0	28,479.4	32,291.7	50,344.4
Other long-term liabilities	6,878.0	9,476.2	12,284.8	16,071.7
Total long-term liabilities	**29,527.0**	**81,941.1**	**115,058.4**	**157,246.1**
Total liabilities	**45,967.0**	**104,375.2**	**148,960.9**	**204,527.6**
Preferred shares	–	–	–	–
Total common equity	**3,335.0**	**4,051.5**	**2,483.2**	**4,768.6**
Minority interest	–	–	–	–
Total liabilities & equity	**49,302.0**	**108,426.7**	**151,444.1**	**209,296.3**
BVPS ($)	7.68	7.32	4.17	7.64

Cash Flow ($ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net income	(1,167.3)	(2,836.9)	(2,394.2)	1,378.2
D&A add-back	2,454.0	6,645.9	13,809.4	22,497.0
Minority interest add-back	–	–	–	–
Net (inc)/dec working capital	632.1	4,732.6	6,950.4	8,696.6
Others	1,139.0	1,846.8	1,422.2	1,583.6
Cash flow from operations	**3,057.8**	**10,388.4**	**19,787.8**	**34,155.4**
Capital expenditures	(10,309.0)	(38,552.2)	(48,001.7)	(49,937.7)
Acquisitions	(108.0)	–	–	–
Divestitures	–	–	–	–
Others	146.0	(757.0)	–	–
Cash flow from investing	**(10,271.0)**	**(39,309.2)**	**(48,001.7)**	**(49,937.7)**
Dividends paid	0.0	–	–	–
Share issuance/(repurchase)	1,491.0	2,982.0	–	–
Inc/(dec) in debt	8,430.0	26,711.4	26,613.2	19,950.5
Others	(941.9)	(927.7)	(180.3)	(85.8)
Cash flow from financing	**8,979.1**	**28,765.7**	**26,432.9**	**19,864.6**
Total cash flow	**1,765.9**	**(155.1)**	**(1,781.0)**	**4,082.3**
Free cash flow	(7,251.2)	(28,163.8)	(28,213.9)	(15,782.3)
Free cash flow per share (basic) ($)	(16.71)	(50.90)	(47.41)	(25.30)

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

normalize and the implications for residual value. However, we believe that datapoints in the next 12 months are likely to be positive for CoreWeave, and we would use this recent correction as an opportunity to buy the stock.

1. Not all neoclouds are created equal, and CoreWeave is likely in the top quartile of neoclouds, if not the top decile, when measured on performance and ability to execute.
We agree that neoclouds offerings will likely commoditize, with the industry likely to consolidate, as supply scales and ultimately comes back into balance with demand. However, we think this bear case often overlooks the significant dispersion in quality across providers. Not all neoclouds are created equal, and we view CoreWeave as being toward the top of the quality rankings in the ecosystem. We define quality as: a) the ability to execute, including deploying and scaling high performance GPU clusters at speed; and b) the potential to build durable moats by moving up the stack beyond pure GPU-aaS infrastructure.

Across the 300+ AI compute providers tracked in SemiAnalysis' ClusterMAX framework (from neoclouds to hyperscalers), CoreWeave benchmarks in the top 2. Our industry conversations suggest that CoreWeave provides 20% higher performance per unit of cost than peers. We believe this is a function of differentiated infrastructure software, cluster management tooling, and operational IP developed specifically around large scale AI workloads. Examples include: i) mission control, its cluster health management system providing real-time infrastructure visibility and automated lifecycle management for AI workloads; ii) SUNK, an orchestration system enabling improved identity federation, research segmentation, and large-scale AI workload management; and iii) CoreWeave Kubernetes Service (CKS), for managing distributed AI workloads with flexibility.

CoreWeave has taken several steps to move up the stack from providing pure infrastructure to a deeper platform of services. At its user conference, CoreWeave introduced its broader platform strategy through Forge, a new development layer that brings together training, inference, evaluation, observability, and agent development into a single platform CoreWeave's hypothesis is that AI is increasingly a continuous feedback loop rather than a linear workflow: models and agents generate production data, that data informs evaluation and post training, and improvements are redeployed into production. Forge is designed to connect those stages so that signals generated during inference can directly inform future model improvements, reducing the fragmentation that exists across today's AI toolchain. CoreWeave also offers Omni, which allows customers to run CoreWeave's software stack on infrastructure that CoreWeave does not own. We believe these product offerings begin to address the key investor debates around whether CoreWeave remains an infrastructure provider or becomes an AI platform, positioning the company as a higher layer participant in the AI stack with increasing exposure to developer workflows, software tooling, and model lifecycle management; helping develop stickiness for when supply/demand normalizes.

2. Our conversations with credit specialists suggest that CoreWeave should still be able to finance its future expansion plans at a cost of debt that is only modestly higher than its current weighted average cost of debt.
Simplistically, we calculate current weighted average cost of debt at 800-900bps, given $640mn of 2Q interest expense (annualized to $2.56bn) divided by ~$30bn of total debt (average in 1H). We see a scenario where new IG-related debt prices closer to 750bps (SOFR+300) and HY-related debt prices closer to 1050bps (SOFR+600).

Based on our industry conversations, CoreWeave will still likely be able to raise DDTLs; and DDTL 5.0 and 5.5 both trade at or above their originally issued discount.
Recall CoreWeave's primary funding method for scaling AI infrastructure is via DDTLs (delayed draw term loans) - these are asset-backed project financings rather than traditional corporate debt. Rather than underwriting CoreWeave's standalone credit profile, lenders are primarily underwriting the combination of a specific long-term customer contract, the underlying GPU infrastructure, and the cash flows generated by that deployment. These facilities are typically secured by the associated GPUs, servers, contract revenues, and related assets, allowing lenders to leverage the credit quality of the end customer in addition to the collateral value of the infrastructure itself. The structures have historically been largely self-amortizing, with debt maturities designed to align with contract terms so that customer payments repay principal over the life of the agreement. As a result, by the time the contract expires, the associated debt has often been substantially or fully repaid, leaving CoreWeave to capture any residual value from the GPU fleet or potential re-leasing opportunities without the burden of ongoing interest expense. More recent transactions, particularly DDTL 5.5, represent an evolution of the model, as lenders appear increasingly active in underwriting not only contracted cash flows but also the future re-contracting potential and residual value of NVIDIA GPU infrastructure, effectively extending financing beyond the duration of the initial customer agreement.

From a risk perspective, DDTLs shift much of the financing risk from CoreWeave's corporate balance sheet to specific customer contracts and infrastructure assets, reducing refinancing risk and limiting the amount of equity required to fund growth. The key investor debate is increasingly around residual value risk: whether NVIDIA GPU clusters will remain highly utilized and capable of being re-contracted after the initial customer agreement expires.

Importantly, our discussions suggest that CoreWeave's unsecured spreads (currently at 13.5-15.0% YTW) are not representative of what CoreWeave's true cost of new debt is; in fact, the unsecured bond market has already been closed to new CoreWeave issuance for several months. That said, we recognize that marginal funding costs have increased as interest rates and credit spreads have moved higher, leading us to raise our financing assumptions to SOFR+300bps for IG offtake (such as tied to the Meta contract) and SOFR+600bps for HY offtake. Based on current SOFR forward curves, this suggests blended cost of debt capital between 750 and 1050bps. For simplicity and to be conservative, we pick 1000bps, and we adjust our interest expense estimates to reflect this.

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Exhibit 1: CoreWeave's unsecured bonds trade at 13.5-15.0% YTW, but we expect new issuance to be asset-backed and in the range of 750-1050bps

	Description	Balance Sheet Amt Out (USD)	Current Amt Out (USD)	Coupon Rate	Coupon Type	Issue Date	Maturity Date	Issue Curr	Seniority	Pricing Data Price	YTW	OAS (LIBOR)
ST Debt		**7,513.0**	**7,513.0**									
	Current Portion Of LTD	7,513.0	7,513.0	-	-	-	-	USD	Other	-		-
Revolving Credit		**0.0**	**0.0**									
	Senior Sec. Revolving Credit Facility	0.0	0.0	7.000%	Variable	06/24	11/29	USD	SNR Sec	-		-
Term Loans		**18,934.0**	**18,934.0**									
	Senior Sec. Delayed Drawdown Term Loan	1,300.0	1,300.0	15.000%	Variable	07/23	03/28	USD	SNR Sec	-	-	-
	Senior Sec. Delayed Drawdown Term Loan	2,215.0	2,215.0	9.000%	Variable	07/25	08/30	USD	SNR Sec	-	-	-
	Senior Sec. Delayed Drawdown Term Loan	3,190.0	3,190.0	11.000%	Variable	05/24	08/30	USD	SNR Sec	-	-	-
	Senior Sec. Delayed Drawdown Term Loan	1,101.0	1,101.0	-	Variable	04/26	11/31	USD	SNR Sec	99.64	9.23%	464.7
	Senior Sec. Delayed Drawdown Term Loan	3,000.0	3,000.0	9.000%	Variable	09/25	03/31	USD	SNR Sec	-		-
	Senior Sec. Delayed Drawdown Term Loan - Non-Recourse	0.0	0.0	-	Variable	03/26	03/32	USD	SNR Sec	99.50	6.99%	230.6
	Senior Sec. Delayed Drawdown Term Loan - Non-Recourse	2,837.0	2,837.0	7.000%	Variable	03/26	03/32	USD	SNR Sec	-		-
	Equipment Loans - Non-Recorse	882.0	882.0	9.000%	Variable	-	Range	USD	Other	-		-
	Magnetar Loan	189.0	189.0	12.000%	Variable	-	01/29	USD	Other	-		-
	Equipment Loans	4,220.0	4,220.0	11.000%	Variable	-	Range	USD	Other	-		-
	Senior Secured Term Loan	-	0.0	-	Variable	08/26	09/31	USD	SNR Sec	-		-
	Senior Secured Term Loan	-	0.0	-	Variable	07/26	09/31	USD	SNR Sec	98.98	10.44%	584.5
Notes/Bonds		**16,617.0**	**20,817.0**									
	Coreweave Inc	2,000.0	2,000.0	9.250%	Fixed	05/25	06/30	USD	SNR Unsec	87.71	13.63%	881.5
	Coreweave Inc	1,750.0	1,750.0	9.000%	Fixed	07/25	02/31	USD	SNR Unsec	84.24	13.98%	916.
	Coreweave Inc	2,750.0	2,750.0	9.750%	Fixed	04/26	10/31	USD	SNR Unsec	83.35	14.57%	974.9
	Coreweave Inc	1,250.0	1,250.0	9.625%	Fixed	06/26	07/32	USD	SNR Unsec	81.59	14.42%	959.8
	Coreweave Inc	2,588.0	2,588.0	1.750%	Fixed	12/25	12/31	USD	SNR Conv	84.60	5.21%	617.9
	Coreweave Inc	4,000.0	4,000.0	1.750%	Fixed	04/26	10/32	USD	SNR Conv	77.39	6.37%	597.7
	Coreweave Inc - 2B EUR	2,279.0	2,279.0	8.500%	Fixed	06/26	07/32	EUR	SNR Unsec	75.45	15.00%	1144.7
	CoreWeave, Inc. 2.875% 01-APR-2033	-	4,200.0	2.875%	Fixed	09/26	04/33	USD	SNR Unsec	90.25	4.64%	598.6

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: CoreWeave's existing DDTLs pair financing with specific contracts

Facility	Close date	Capacity ($bn)	Principal drawn ($bn)	Drawn date	Undrawn ($bn)	Utilization	Pricing / effective rate	Maturity	Payment terms	Underlying contract / use	Borrower / collateral / recourse	Ratings	Read through
DDTL 1.0	Jul 2023	$2.3	$1.4	Mar 31, 2026	$0.9	63%	15% effective	Mar 2028	Amortizing; public summary indicates repayments started at 5% of balance; remaining schedule not separately disclosed	GPU and infrastructure financing tied to contracted deployments; customer not publicly named	CoreWeave Compute Acquisition Co. II; parent guaranteed; asset backed	Not publicly disclosed	Legacy, highest cost DDTL; balance is amortizing
DDTL 2.0	May 2024	$7.6	$4.4	Mar 31, 2026	$3.2	58%	11% effective; pricing varies by customer credit quality	Aug 2030	Quarterly principal installments; exact current schedule not separately disclosed	Infrastructure supporting multiple customer contracts; specific customers not publicly mapped	CoreWeave Compute Acquisition Co. IV; parent guaranteed; secured by financed assets and contract cash flows	Not publicly disclosed	Large legacy pool; cheaper than 1.0 but expensive vs. later investment grade structure
DDTL 2.1	Sep 2025	$3.0	$3.0	Mar 31, 2026	-	100%	9% effective	Mar 2031	Amortizing project financing; detailed schedule not separately disclosed	New tranche within 2.0 framework; customer mapping not publicly disclosed	CoreWeave Compute Acquisition Co. IV; parent guaranteed; secured	Not publicly disclosed	Fully drawn by Mar 2026; pricing improved vs. 2.0
DDTL 3.0	Jul 2025	$2.6	$1.7	Mar 31, 2026	$0.9	65%	SOFR + 4.00%; 9% effective at Mar 31, 2026	Aug 21, 2030	Delayed draws align with deployment; scheduled amortization and cash waterfall under credit agreement	Long term OpenAI agreement; equipment, hardware and cloud infrastructure	CCAC VII and Co. V; substantially all CCAC VII assets; parent guaranteed	Not publicly disclosed	Clear contract linkage and improving spread, but floating rate exposure remains
DDTL 4.0	Mar 30, 2026	$8.5	$1.3	Mar 31, 2026	$7.2	15%	$4.5bn floating at SOFR + 2.25%; $4.0bn fixed near 5.9%; 7% effective	Mar 31, 2032	Monthly principal begins after earliest of commitment termination, delayed site amortization, or top up draw; residual due at maturity	Previously contracted cloud services with a leading AI enterprise; customer not publicly named	CCAC VIII; substantially all borrower assets; nonrecourse except customary carve outs	A3 Moody's; A low DBRS	Best credit quality and lowest spread; contract quality and nonrecourse drive lower cost
DDTL 5.0	May 15, 2026	$3.1	Not separately disclosed		N/A	N/A	SOFR + 4.50%	Approx. Nov 2031	Delayed draws aligned to GPU deployment and useful life; detailed amortization in credit agreement	Infrastructure dedicated to contracts with two large noninvestment grade customers	CoreWeave Financing DDTL V; SPV; secured HPC infrastructure and contract cash flows	Ba2 Moody's; BB+ Fitch	Public syndication broadened funding; wider spread reflects weaker customer credit vs. 4.0
DDTL 5.5	Aug 2026	$2.6	Not yet in a reported quarter		N/A	N/A	SOFR + 5.50%	Approx. Aug 2031	Debt extends beyond average contract term; renewal or re lease required after initial contracts	Diverse AI, financial services and technology customers; average contract term about 3 years	CoreWeave Financing DDTL V V; SPV; HPC infrastructure and contract backed	Ba2 Moody's; BB+ Fitch	First DDTL with explicit recontracting risk; flexibility improves TAM but raises residual value risk

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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3. Our uIRR math suggests that CoreWeave should clear a 15% uIRR for at least the next 24 months.

CoreWeave's blended monetization today is ~$10mn/MW, based on ARR/prior period active power (to account for timing of capacity coming online). We believe this should increase: CoreWeave has disclosed short-term contracts (3-6months) are signed at $40mn/MW, and has raised prices by 25% in July and another 10% in October. We expect these pricing benefits to flow through to consolidated ARR/MW more gradually than at peers that predominantly offer spot or on-demand compute, given the longer-dated nature of CoreWeave's contracts (with average contract length ~4-5 years), but nonetheless expect monetization per MW to continue trending higher driven by three factors: 1) new generations of GPUs should command higher pricing, though this is likely the least value accretive driver given it is accompanied by higher capex per MW; 2) continued supply-demand tightness across the AI infrastructure market. Notably, contracts signed in 2Q carried contribution margins 5-10 points above more recent cohorts (recall CoreWeave targets mid-20% contribution margins); and 3) we see an increasing contribution from higher-margin software and platform offerings, including managed inference and Omni (discussed above). As these services become a larger portion of the revenue mix, they should increase revenue generated per MW without a commensurate increase in underlying infrastructure investment, supporting higher ARR/MW and incremental returns on deployed capital. Taken together, our industry conversations with customers and competitors suggests $13mn/MW is an appropriate starting assumption for new longer-term contracts coming online.

Exhibit 3: Our illustrative CRWV contract suggests that uIRR could be 15%, before adjusting for residual value

Original Deal Size ($m)	$10,000	**Original contracted deal value**
Base ARR / MW ($m)	**$10.0**	CoreWeave cosolidated ARR/MW
Price-Adjusted Deal Size ($m)	**$13,000**	Price-adjusted ARR / MW × capacity × duration
Price-Adjusted ARR / MW ($m)	**$13.0**	
EBITDA Margin	77.5%	CoreWeave target contract margins (75-80%)
Original Revenue / Capex	1.67x	Original deal size ÷ derived capex
Derived Capex	6,000	Capacity × capex / MW
Derived Capacity (MW)	200.0	Original deal ÷ base ARR / MW ÷ duration
Capex / MW ($m)	$30.0	CoreWeave 2025 capex
Duration	5	Contract duration historically averages 4-5 years
Useful life	6	Contract duration historically averages 4-5 years
Debt funding	80%	CoreWeave historical financing assumption
Interest rate	10.0%	Implied new cost of debt
Residual Value	0.0%	% of annual contract price

	Y0	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5	Y6	
Revenue		2,600	2,600	2,600	2,600	2,600	0	13,000
Opex		585	585	585	585	585	0	
EBITDA		2,015	2,015	2,015	2,015	2,015	0	
Inflows		2,015	2,015	2,015	2,015	2,015	0	10,075
Debt funding	4,800							
Interest Expense		*480*	*384*	*288*	*192*	*96*		
Debt Service		*960*	*960*	*960*	*960*	*960*		
Total Debt	4,800	3,840	2,880	1,920	960	0	0	
Organic Funding	1,200							
Outflows	1,200	1,440	1,344	1,248	1,152	1,056	0	
								IRRs
Unlevered FCF (Pre-Tax)	(6,000)	2,015	2,015	2,015	2,015	2,015	0	20%
Cash Taxes		213	213	213	213	213	0	
Unlevered FCF	**(6,000)**	**1,802**	**1,802**	**1,802**	**1,802**	**1,802**	**0**	**15%**

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: Adjusting for pricing, we believe uIRR is in the range of 15-21%, well ahead of WACC in today's financing environment

Illustrative sensitivities to uIRR and WACC

Post-Tax Unlevered IRR v. Annualized Revenue / MW

$m / MW-year	$10	$11	$12	$13	$14	$15
Post-Tax Unlevered IRR	6.3%	9.4%	12.4%	15.3%	18.1%	20.9%

WACC v. Interest Rate

Interest Rate	7%	8%	9%	10%	11%	12%
WACC	10.7%	11.1%	11.4%	11.8%	12.2%	12.6%

Post-Tax Unlevered IRR – WACC Spread Matrix

Interest Rate / $m per MW-year	$10	$11	$12	$13	$14	$15
7%	-4%	-1%	2%	5%	7%	10%
8%	-5%	-2%	1%	4%	7%	10%
9%	-5%	-2%	1%	4%	7%	9%
10%	-6%	-2%	1%	3%	6%	9%
11%	-6%	-3%	0%	3%	6%	9%
12%	-6%	-3%	0%	3%	6%	8%

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Our analysis does not assume any GPU residual value beyond the 5-year contract, which we believe is conservative. Our industry discussions today support the view that older generation GPUs may have longer useful lives than initially expected. CoreWeave customer examples include: 1) a 3YR A100 (launched in 2020) contract renewed into 2029 at pricing in line with typical 1yr terms; and 2) a 3YR H100 (launched in 2023) contract renewed at a premium to the original contract. We have also heard that industry contracts now sometimes even commit to 7 years. **When assuming residual value in Y6 without any change in pricing, uIRR goes to 20-25%.**

While some of this demand may reflect ongoing industry capacity constraints, it is also tied to workload continuity, software optimization, and the benefits of staying on proven architectures that are already embedded within research and development workflows. The key debate is how much of the observed demand reflects genuine longevity of older architectures versus customers taking whatever capacity is available. In our view, the answer is likely somewhere in between: capacity scarcity may be extending the economic life of older GPUs, but these renewals also suggest that for certain workloads, the performance benefits of the latest generation may not outweigh the costs and disruption associated with migrating established infrastructure and workflows.

The residual value question is particularly important for CoreWeave because it can create upside through two mechanisms: 1) CoreWeave can continue monetizing infrastructure that has already been partially or fully depreciated; and 2) the company's DDTLs are generally structured to amortize alongside the underlying contract, meaning debt balances are substantially repaid by the time the initial customer commitment expires. **As a result, any renewal or re-contracting opportunity can generate materially higher margins, as the infrastructure is already deployed and much of the associated financing burden has been removed. These high-margin cash flows could become an important source of internally generated capital to fund future growth.**

Exhibit 5: Assuming 100% of residual value in Y6, implies uIRR is between ~20-25%
Sensitivities to uIRR and WACC

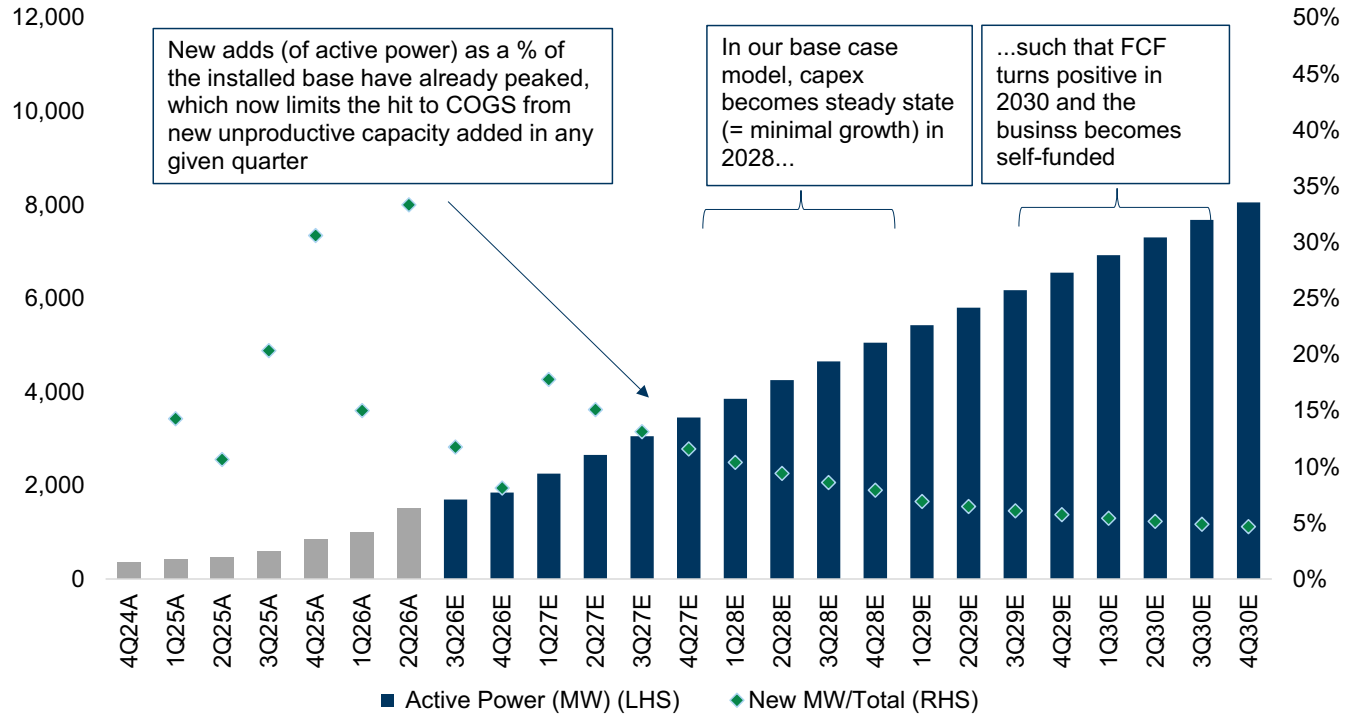
Post-Tax Unlevered IRR v. Annualized Revenue / MW						
$m / MW-year	$10	$11	$12	$13	$14	$15
Post-Tax Unlevered IRR	11.4%	14.3%	17.2%	19.9%	22.7%	25.3%

WACC v. Interest Rate						
Interest Rate	7%	8%	9%	10%	11%	12%
WACC	10.7%	11.1%	11.4%	11.8%	12.2%	12.6%

Post-Tax Unlevered IRR – WACC Spread Matrix						
Interest Rate / $m per MW-year	$10	$11	$12	$13	$14	$15
7%	1%	4%	7%	9%	12%	15%
8%	0%	3%	6%	9%	12%	14%
9%	0%	3%	6%	9%	11%	14%
10%	0%	3%	5%	8%	11%	13%
11%	-1%	2%	5%	8%	10%	13%
12%	-1%	2%	5%	7%	10%	13%

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

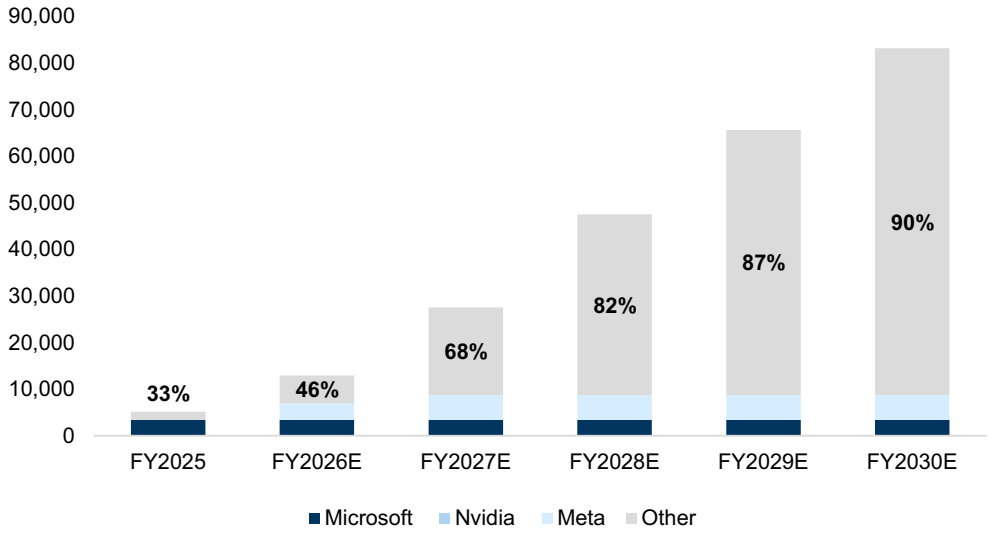
Exhibit 6: As new capacity comes online as a smaller percent of total capacity, existing ramps can fund new ramps



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

4. We expect supply/demand constraints to persist at least for the next 24 months This was one of the clearest takeaways from our September Conference (Communacopia): we heard from several companies that AI infrastructure demand is exceptionally strong, even when accounting for mix shift between frontier and open source/weight tokens; and that enterprises are increasingly moving AI workloads into production and treating compute as a strategic resource. Over the course of 2026, multiple datapoints have reinforced CoreWeave's view that supply/demand will be tight through 2030. While we believe there are too many unknowns to take a view on demand through 2030, we think on balance the next 24 months will show a worsening supply/demand imbalance, rather than an improving one. For context, we estimate that frontier labs comprise ~20-30% of CoreWeave's backlog, and it has increasingly highlighted new wins from enterprise customers like IBM and Caterpillar. Importantly, we think demand is not a function of progress or monetization on the frontier, but rather a function of enterprise diffusion.

Exhibit 7: Estimated customer concentration based on large deal announcements



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

The token demand curve for Robotics will likely create another lever to longer-term data center demand dynamics. Recall we introduced our estimate that demand for tokens would increase 24x in the next 5 years in our agentic economy report. This estimate contemplates text to more complex imaging to more complex agentic step ups. The world models curve would layer on top of this. Industry experts argue that developing a competitive world model may require frontier-model-level scale in both compute and data. Internet-scale data is increasingly insufficient to train models, and more real-world data is generated every minute relative to the entire internet corpus. Taken together, progress over the next several years may require select world model companies operating at similar compute scale to today's frontier LLM models. In our conversations with CoreWeave, our understanding is that relative to LLMs, world model customers value a) AI object storage, given more data; b) bandwidth performance, with Infiniband driving better performance than Ethernet; c) zero egress, given higher amounts of data egress. World model customers tend to use GPUs for both computing and data processing, whereas CPUs do the heavy lifting on data processing for LLMs.

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In a world where cost of financing goes up for all compute providers, supply growth slows and acts as a brake to smooth out an eventual supply/demand normalization and mitigate the risks of an overbuild. In that scenario, providers of supply become more valuable in the near term, not less.

Valuation & Key Risks

Our 12-month revised price target is $106, based on 18x SNTM EBIT (Q5-Q8). Our framework for valuation considers the next 2-3 years, rather than going out further in time to a period of more normalized growth. As such, our goal was to get comfortable with the near-term set up, and outline a scenario as to where the stock could trade over the next year, rather than introduce a longer-term valuation framework. Our 18x target multiple implies 10x Q9-Q12 EBIT, essentially 3 years out, given how quickly CoreWeave is ramping EBIT. This 10x multiple reflects about a 50% discount to the hyperscalers (that trade in the low 20s on EV/EBIT NTM, having already scaled their businesses) and a 30% discount to ORCL (at 14x EV/EBIT NTM, with strong FCF from its apps/database businesses but having yet to have scaled its cloud business). We believe this discount appropriately takes into account CoreWeave's risk profile for equity holders, including its high absolute levels of debt. Our prior $139 price target was based on 22x EV/EBIT to CoreWeave's SNTM non-GAAP EBIT.

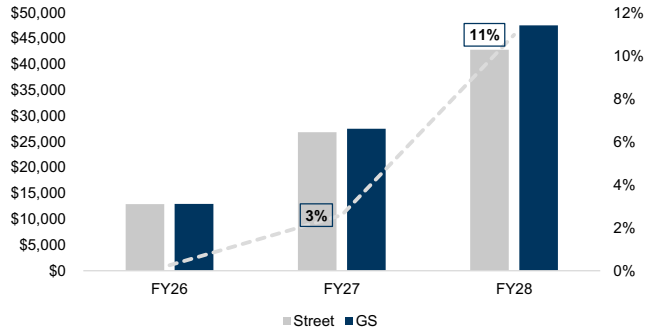
Exhibit 8: Our CRWV multiple implies 10x on Y3 EBIT, a 30% discount to ORCL and a 50%+ discount to hyperscalers to reflect CRWV's higher risk profile, including its high absolute levels of debt

Date	10/16/2026

Company	Ticker	Sales Growth		Operating Margins		EV / EBIT			EV / EBIT / Growth		
		2028	2029	2028	2029	NTM	2028	2029	NTM	2028	2029
Microsoft	MSFT	21%	20%	46%	47%	22x	17x	14x	1.3x	0.8x	0.7x
Oracle	ORCL	47%	27%	37%	38%	14x	9x	7x	0.4x	0.2x	0.3x
Amazon	AMZN	20%	8%	18%	19%	23x	14x	13x	1.7x	0.7x	1.6x
Google	GOOG	24%	12%	36%	38%	22x	15x	13x	0.9x	0.6x	1.1x
Average		**28%**	**17%**	**34%**	**35%**	**20x**	**14x**	**12x**	**1.05x**	**0.60x**	**0.91x**
Median		**22%**	**16%**	**36%**	**38%**	**22x**	**15x**	**13x**	**1.08x**	**0.69x**	**0.92x**
CoreWeave	**CRWV**	**73%**	**38%**	**21%**	**24%**	**33x**	**8x**	**5x**	**0.20x**	**0.11x**	**0.14x**

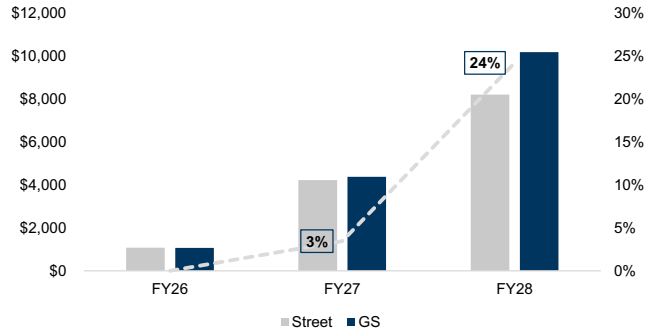
Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 9: We are 11% above the Street on revenue for 2028, primarily driven by updated ARR/MW assumptions
GS Revenue estimates vs. Street



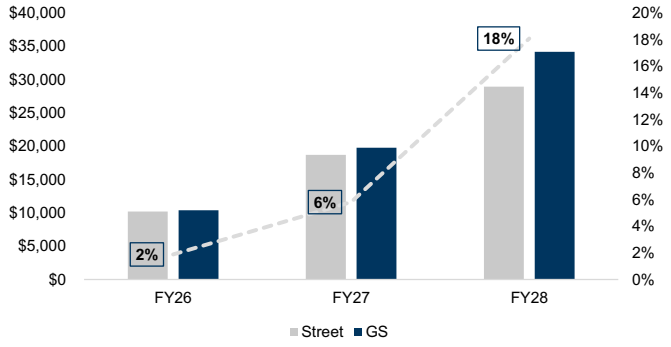
Source: Visible Alpha Consensus Data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 10: We are 24% above the Street on EBIT for 2028, in part as we take into account new unramped capacity already having peaked as a ratio of ramped capacity in any given year



Source: Visible Alpha Consensus Data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 11: GS Capex vs. Street



Source: Visible Alpha Consensus Data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Key risks

1. What if the market is not questioning how good ROIC is, but instead implicitly questioning if ROIC is too good? With the spot market at $40-50mn/MW in monetization and capex at $40-50mn/MW in cost, the spot market implies a payback period of 1 year on capex, which is well in excess of what normalized returns would be in a typical capital cycle (recall CoreWeave has discussed a 2.5 year payback period on GPUs and Google has discussed its payback on AI servers is less than 2 years). As such, the cost of capital would need to go up to subsidize investors for the risk that the industry is close to or at peak ROIC. We agree that spot prices will have to normalize down – however, only a very limited portion of CoreWeave's business would be able to capture spot, and we think CoreWeave's longer-term contracting structure will help smooth spot-market type returns over a longer period of time.

2. What happens when supply/demand normalizes?

- The biggest risk in our view is that market pricing collapses, such that contract renewals in Y4-6 collapse to a price point that no longer clears the WACC hurdle, while CoreWeave is still locked into longer term 7-16 year data center leases. To mitigate this downside, the vast majority of CoreWeave's loans are secured against specific contracts where pricing is locked in, such that it generally covers the debt schedule and payback. The risk would be around the residual value of GPUs in Y4.5-6.0. We acknowledge the limited visibility we have over the next 12 months, and it is not yet clear to us where unit economics move to long term. However, in the meanwhile, CoreWeave is moving up the stack and this suggests that residual value may be higher than the value of GPU-aaS contracts alone (and this residual value is less tied to S/D dynamics, and more tied to technology differentiation). If CoreWeave succeeds with this effort, we see a scenario where CoreWeave would trade at better than 10x our Y3 EBIT estimate.
- The other risk to consider is that CoreWeave's large-scale customers (e.g. Microsoft at ~12% based on GSe) do not renew their contracts because they have a stated priority of hosting capacity in house wherever possible, and this limits CoreWeave's TAM only to customers that do not want to insource capacity. The key here will be whether new enterprise customers can be a big enough TAM to offset hyperscalers

moving capacity back in house.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Gabriela Borges, CFA and Maura Hager, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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Contributing Authors: Gabriela Borges, CFA Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC, Maura Hager Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC.

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

For a more detailed description of how we calculate the GS Factor Profile, please contact your GS representative.

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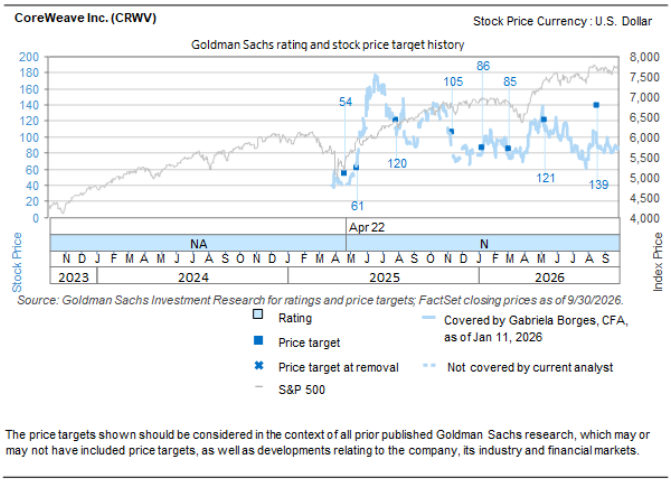
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	Buy	Hold	Sell	Buy	Hold	Sell
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Target price history table(s)

CoreWeave Inc. (CRWV)

Date of report	Target price ($)	Closing price ($)
20-Aug-26	139.00	89.76
11-May-26	121.00	114.70
03-Mar-26	85.00	73.78
11-Jan-26	86.00	80.14
14-Nov-25	105.00	77.36
29-Jul-25	120.00	108.74
15-May-25	61.00	65.77
22-Apr-25	54.00	38.51

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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